



Rep. Tom Emmer on Squawk Box

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HOST JOE:

Preview House Majority Whip Congressman Tom Emmer. Congressman, it's good to see you. Thanks for joining us this morning.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Good to see you, Joe.

HOST JOE:

So much to talk about leading up to the midterms, but the events of the past eight days, or I guess now it's longer than that. It's 10 days. That must be taking center stage with everything you're talking about down there with your colleagues.

REP. TOM EMMER:

I have no doubt, Joe, that that will be one of the main topics of conversation. But you know, this retreat that's being held here in Florida at Doral, the president will address the group tonight. So I'm sure there'll be discussions. But it's about the agenda going forward, and it's about understanding and agreeing what we're going to be doing over the next few months as we head into the midterms to enact the America First agenda that the president ran on and come out of this thing unified.

HOST JOE:

I just hesitate to use the walking and chewing gum because it's such a weighty, serious issue that we're having, but it just seems like talking about reconciliation, another bill, or legislation with the elephant in the room with the war on Iran. We don't know how the war on Iran is going to play out. Do you need to make assumptions about that? How will it be mixed in or factored into all your discussions about what to do before the midterm?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Look, it is a pretty weighty topic, obviously. And our members have been talking about it not since it began, but as the assets were being moved. So this has been something that everybody's been paying attention to and have been involved in. Joe, look, this is the number one sponsor of terrorism in the world. Operation Epic Fury is to, in limited scope, to stop them from ever having any offensive ability to attack the United States of America and or US assets in the area. I believe it is already being extremely successful, and I believe it'll be over in short order.

HOST JOE:

That would be, obviously, the best case scenario, over in short order, because if the GOP had a problem or if it was trying to address affordability and the president addressing that with oil over \$100, suddenly it becomes the



war on Iran, as well as what happens domestically with prices.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, yesterday, I think, a barrel of oil was at \$105. So your point's well taken. As the president has said, this is a short-term experience. This is a short-term cost to literally deal with the chief sponsor of terrorism. No other terrorist organization in the world, Joe, has killed more Americans than this regime in Iran. So as the president says, this is a very focused approach to eliminate their offensive capabilities. Yes, there are going to be some temporary effects on our domestic economy, but as soon as this is taken care of, those prices will tumble and people will recognize that this was a short-term cost to pay for a major long-term gain in the terms of peace and security, not only at home, Joe, but around the globe.

BECKY:

Congressman, two questions. Do you think if the regime, the Iranian regime, had a nuclear weapon, they would use it right now? And second, how do you propose or what do you propose we do about the enriched uranium that's there?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, they should never have a nuclear weapon, Becky. I mean, that has been the point. And people can argue all they want, but the administration has said that they were two weeks away. We know that they have an ample amount of enriched uranium in order to do this, and they could have produced very quickly. So if that's not an imminent threat, I don't know what you define as an imminent threat. President Trump took decisive and bold action.

BECKY:

But does that mean we need to go to the ground to get a hold of the enriched uranium stockpiles that are there?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, Becky, let's not speculate on what the next step is. Our incredible military men and women, the operation that they're conducting right now, very focused and being very successful. There is no Navy. There is no, really no air. We control the air over Tehran. They're flying helicopters over Tehran. If you can't shoot down a helicopter from 500 feet, clearly have lost your, losing your offensive abilities and your defensive ability. So let's see once this gets done, whether there's a change in the regime. I tend to think there will be. The Iranian people have had enough, just like the rest of the world. And thank God President Trump is willing to make these decisions.

ANDREW:

Majority Whip, there's some speculation that if this continues and continues for a long stretch of time, it could have a real impact on the economic ability of China and whether they would try in some way to intervene. How do you assess that risk?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, Andrew, that's the whole point. Let's not speculate. What we should be talking about is the fact that at a time when we've never been more at risk, our homeland has never been more at risk, we have Democrats in this country that refuse to fund the Department of Homeland Security. And they claim it's because they want reforms with Immigrations and Customs Enforcement when that is funded through 2029. In fact, they're harming



the Coast Guard. We have Coast Guard, kids that are serving in our Coast Guard are stationed in the Middle East and they're not gonna get a paycheck. This is outrageous. It's TSA. You had five hour waits in Dallas and New Orleans yesterday. This is not acceptable. That's where we should be focused. It's time when we're in periods like this, where the president is trying to take care of a 50 year problem and a threat to this country's homeland. It's time that we all recognize that this is about the American people, not about our politics. We should be talking about that.

HOST JOE:

Will there be talk about a legislation for a second reconciliation? Bill, do you feel like trying to whip those votes up again, Congressman?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, it was so easy, Joe. I'm not gonna get ahead of Mike Johnson, our speaker. This is part of the discussion over the next couple of days, what the agenda is, what is the art of possible when it comes to reconciliation. It's something that our speaker is very interested in pursuing. And I'm sure that's going to be part of the discussion. Once we know what the answer is from the entire membership, then we'll get to work.

HOST JOE:

Congressman, Majority Whip Emmer, thank you. Give our best to the speaker. We haven't seen him in a while. I'd love to have him on to talk about these things. He's, I don't know, has he got a personal trainer in the morning now or something? You'll see him down there, right? Will you put in a good word for us?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yes. You're here. All right. Joe, we'll always put in a good word for Squadron, yes.

HOST JOE:

Thank you, thank you.

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